Delivering Hard Facts

Shankar Kisan Khondge, a dabbawala, is one of around 1,500 tiffin box carriers who ensure that thousands in Mumbai can have a home-cooked meal at their workplace. Khondge stays in Mulund in suburban Mumbai with his wife Ankita and infant daughter Raavi and says his decision will be influenced by factors like rising inflation and unemployment, and the growing privatisation of the education sector and consequent rise in school fees.



"Issues like the Ram Temple have zero effect on voters. We want to know why good schools and hospitals can't be built," he says. Khondge is also upset at mega industrial projects being wooed by Maharashtra shifting to Gujarat, like the Rs 1.54 lakh crore Vedanta-Foxconn semiconductor plant which was to come up at Talegaon, near his village. "The project would have helped the village youth," he explains. In Mumbai, he says, water supply is a pressing issue in slums, while roads are non-existent there. ■

-Dhaval S. Kulkarni

SHANKAR KISAN KHONDGE, 27
Dabbawala

Lok Sabha constituency: Mumbai North East

What will influence his vote: Rising prices, unemployment, growing privatisation of education and hike in school fees



ABID BHAT

SEEKING A SECULAR INDIA

ISHFAQ HUSSAIN KAWA, 27
Singer

Lok Sabha constituency: Baramulla, J&K

AMAN CHOUDHARY, 29
Travel consultant

Lok Sabha constituency: Jaipur, Rajasthan

Top 3 demands: Instil civic sense among people, create new tourist attractions, maintain pace of India's growth

What will influence his vote: Promises of the local candidates in the fray



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

All for Accountability

"Modiji has put the country on the right track but it is high time he starts grooming a successor who can deliver like him"

Following in his father's footsteps, Aman Choudhary joined the tourism industry after obtaining a graduate degree in hospitality management and MBA in human resources. Spending six years working abroad, including a stint on a world tour cruise, has shaped his vision for a Viksit Bharat. A keen voter, Choudhary wants an accountable government at the Centre, and, given the present options, he is clear that only Prime Minister Narendra Modi can lead it. "Modiji has put the country on the right track," he adds, "but it is high time he starts grooming a successor." But as far as his vote is concerned, Choudhary will choose the candidate based on their promises and what their party has done for the travel and tourism industry. For that matter, he appreciates the Modi regime for constructing the Ram temple in Ayodhya, which has given a fillip to India's tourism industry. While giving the thumbs-up to the abolition of triple talaq and abrogation of Article 370, he feels the Opposition's promise of caste census and freebies will not influence voters. ■

-Rohit Parihar